# Brewery Business Plan Sample (Canada)

This **brewery business plan sample** presents **Granite Finch Brewing Inc.**, a fictional Canadian company proposed for Guelph, Ontario. It is clearly labelled a **SAMPLE**: no real business, client engagement, operating result or investment offer is depicted. Use this brewery business plan example to understand how ten connected sections turn an operating idea into an evidence-based financing discussion. Return to the sample business plan hub to compare other models.

**All company details, commercial prices, demand, capacity, costs and financial projections are illustrative assumptions.** They are not observed market statistics, professional advice or promises of revenue, profit, occupancy or financing approval. Official regulatory sources were checked on October 26, 2026; the appendix distinguishes those requirements from the fictional operating choices. Confirm current rules for the actual application and premises.

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## 1. Sample executive summary

Granite Finch Brewing Inc. proposes a small craft brewery with a proposed taproom and limited wholesale packaged-beer distribution. Its initial customer focus is local adult customers and selected licensed trade accounts seeking a consistent core beer range. The founder will launch within a deliberately defined service scope, validate demand locally and expand only when the staffing, equipment and cash required to deliver additional sales are available. The proposed Guelph, Ontario location is fictional; no particular lease, building approval or customer contract has been secured.

The illustrative capitalization is $800,000, comprising $400,000 owner equity and $400,000 requested borrowing. Installed assets use $550,000; inventory and opening liquidity are separately identified in section 8. The funding request is conditional on quotes, premises due diligence, professional review and lender underwriting. No grant or future investor contribution fills an unexplained gap. The founder will document the equity source and retain enough liquidity for the operating ramp.

The first operating year illustrates revenue of $540,000 and a net result of ($84,000) under the selected assumptions. These numbers teach the relationship between volume, cost and capitalization. They are not a forecast for an actual brewery. Before launch, management must reconcile a monthly schedule with the annual statements, replace assumed inputs with evidence and resolve any conditions that prevent lawful delivery.

> *What a reviewer reads for: a specific offer, an achievable delivery model, a traceable funding requirement and clear conditions before spending. A polished narrative cannot replace verified demand or sufficient cash.*

## 2. Sample company overview

The sample assumes a founder-controlled Canadian corporation operating in Guelph, Ontario. The fictional company name is a teaching identifier and has not been checked for business-name availability. Ownership, shareholder funding and signing authority will be documented before the corporation enters binding contracts. Separate business banking and accounting records will distinguish capital contributions, operating receipts, customer obligations and owner compensation.

Provincial AGCO manufacturer licensing and relevant sales permissions are assessed separately from federal CRA beer-excise licensing. The selected Ontario licensing regulation and CRA circular support qualitative process framing. The forecast includes a provisional commercial cost envelope that must be replaced with the applicable current tax calculation; no excise rate or reduced-rate entitlement is claimed.

The founder will negotiate premises and major purchase commitments around the actual approval sequence. A letter of intent should distinguish due diligence from an unconditional lease obligation. Landlord consent, permitted use, installation responsibilities, repair obligations, insurance and restoration terms require review before fit-out begins. Provincial professional or sector authorization, municipal premises decisions and lender approval are separate decisions; success in one process does not settle the others.

## 3. Sample services and revenue model

Taproom receipts are assumed at $360,000, $450,000 and $520,000, with wholesale receipts of $180,000, $250,000 and $320,000. Direct materials, packaging, variable distribution and a provisional tax/compliance cost envelope total 35 per cent of taproom receipts and 55 per cent of wholesale receipts. These cost ratios are assumptions, not excise or Ontario tax rates. The wholesale selling price is not the taproom menu price, and wholesale volume cannot be valued as though every litre were sold directly to a guest.

The launch offer is a small craft brewery with a proposed taproom and limited wholesale packaged-beer distribution. Written proposals or customer terms will identify what is included, what costs extra, the expected delivery window and how changes are approved. The founder will price the actual work and resources involved rather than copy a competitor’s headline price. Optional products and services remain optional; their forecast depends on separate customer acceptance and sufficient delivery capacity.

The manager will maintain a service-and-product matrix showing unit, net price, direct cost, paid staff time and capacity constraint. This makes it possible to compare an attractive sales total with the contribution actually retained. Packages must allocate revenue consistently rather than count an included service twice. Any new offer requires a revised cost sheet and an assessment of its licensing, insurance, training and working-capital implications before it is added to the sales forecast.

## 4. Sample market analysis

The proposed catchment is the area the Guelph, Ontario team can serve reliably with its initial resources. The target is local adult customers and selected licensed trade accounts seeking a consistent core beer range. No local customer count, market-share estimate or industry search volume is asserted. The founder will collect current evidence through customer interviews, dated competitor observations, location visits and supplier discussions, recording what is observed separately from what remains an estimate.

Research should answer specific buying questions: what triggers a purchase, who decides, how often the need recurs, which alternatives are already used and what would justify switching. Interview notes are evidence about those respondents, not a representative survey unless the method supports that claim. Advertised competitor prices need their scope, date and tax treatment recorded; an unavailable promotion should not become the permanent benchmark for the model.

Use the TAM, SAM and SOM glossary to define the broad opportunity, the portion reachable under the actual offer and geography, and the smaller share that launch capacity could serve. Build the obtainable case from the bottom up: available staff hours, equipment or calendar capacity, feasible throughput and net collected price. This sample deliberately publishes no invented market size. National industry revenue cannot establish that one proposed location will attract enough paying customers.

> *Adaptation note: evidence for a business plan for a brewery should support the selected customer, location and capacity. Replace a vague claim that demand is strong with the actual research method, findings and remaining uncertainty.*

## 5. Sample operations plan

Production planning starts with sellable litres by channel, then works back through batch yield, fermentation time, tank availability, packaging and quality release. The illustrative annual rhythm allocates 35 per cent of sales to summer, 25 per cent to autumn and 20 per cent each to winter and spring; this is a scenario, not a reported seasonal market statistic. Brewing ahead of peak demand ties up cash and creates ageing risk. The brewer will use batch records, sanitation logs, traceability and measured losses rather than treat nominal tank volume as finished saleable beer.

**Ontario — O. Reg. 746/21, Licensing:** The current consolidated licensing regulation distinguishes licence classes and permissions. Management will confirm the actual AGCO licence, premises eligibility, product permissions, staff obligations and operating conditions before opening. No historical rollout dates, licence fee, alcohol-content threshold or automatic approval timeline is used in the forecast. Read the official source.

**Canada Revenue Agency — ED200-1, Licensing requirements for manufacturers of beer:** CRA describes federal licensing requirements for beer manufacturing and relevant physical business locations. The operator will confirm its manufacturing, storage and reporting arrangements before production; provincial retail permission does not replace federal excise licensing. Read the official source.

Opening will follow milestones rather than an unsupported fixed approval date: premises feasibility, conditional commercial terms, required authorization, installed equipment, trained staff, tested systems and readiness review. Rent, finance charges and pre-opening payroll can continue while a milestone is unresolved. The manager will assign each open condition an owner and decision date, then update the cash forecast if it moves. Customer bookings must not imply that a proposed launch is authorized when it is still conditional.

## 6. Sample marketing and sales plan

The brewery will introduce a small core range and test repeat purchases before expanding seasonal products. Trade outreach focuses on accounts that fit delivery capacity. Taproom promotions and events will be reviewed against licence permissions. Marketing will not imply that a manufacturer licence automatically allows every form of retail sale, off-site event or on-premises service.

The sales register will distinguish an enquiry, a qualified opportunity, a signed commitment, completed delivery and a collected receipt. Each stage has a different evidentiary value. A campaign will have a defined spending limit and review point; the owner will compare acquisition spending with contribution after direct delivery costs

rather than compare advertising spend only with gross revenue. Existing-customer activity is tracked separately from newly acquired customers so repeat orders do not artificially reduce the apparent acquisition cost.

Customer complaints, credits and cancellations feed the operating review. A credible response includes a named contact, a record of the issue and authority to resolve it. Management will review whether promised service is consistent with the actual roster and capacity. Demand generated for an unavailable time slot or unavailable product is not usable revenue. When paid acquisition is unproven, the plan should retain a small controlled test rather than assume unlimited affordable leads.

## 7. Sample management and staffing

A working brewer-owner manages quality and production. Paid brewing, packaging and taproom coverage are included in payroll, with staff trained for the actual authorized activities. Adding wholesale accounts requires delivery and account-management time. Management reviews taproom scheduling separately from brew-day labour so evening service does not exhaust the production team.

Before hiring, management will turn the payroll envelope into positions, paid hours, wages, employer costs, leave coverage and training time. Contractor arrangements require a genuine assessment of the working relationship, not a label chosen solely to reduce payroll. Sensitive customer, employee and business records will have defined access and retention procedures appropriate to the actual operation. The founder will obtain qualified advice where employment, privacy or professional obligations apply rather than infer them from this example.

Licensing delay, a contaminated batch, unsold seasonal beer or a packaging problem can consume cash before any sale. The founder will maintain recall and product-hold procedures, inspect refrigeration performance and avoid financing permanent overhead with one festival weekend. Wholesale customers may pay later than taproom guests, making channel mix a working-capital decision as well as a gross-margin decision.

The weekly management review will compare delivered units, net selling price, direct cost, paid hours, cash collected, overdue balances and upcoming commitments. A variance needs a cause and an action: a price change cannot repair a capacity shortage, and higher sales do not fix late collections. The founder will appoint backup authority for essential approvals and keep contact details for suppliers, insurers, advisers and emergency support accessible to the responsible staff.

## 8. Illustrative financial projections

**All financial amounts, prices, volumes, percentages and projections below are illustrative assumptions in Canadian dollars, not market benchmarks, approved credit terms or promised results.** Years 1–3 mean the first three operating years after an authorized opening. Annual totals do not establish adequate monthly liquidity. Management must schedule actual launch costs, seasonality, customer payment dates and loan instalments before presenting a financing case. Sales exclude sales taxes; actual tax collected or recoverable belongs in separate control accounts. Unrecoverable purchase taxes must be included in the relevant real cost quotes.

## Illustrative opening sources and uses

| Use | Amount | Source | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Fit-out and equipment** | $550,000 | Owner equity | $400,000 |

| Use | Amount | Source | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Opening inventory at cost** | $30,000 | Requested borrowing | $400,000 |
| **Opening cash and reserves** | $220,000 | Grants assumed | $0 |
| **Total uses** | $800,000 | Total sources | $800,000 |

Illustrative financing-close capitalization, CAD

The opening balance sheet assumes $550,000 of installed fit-out and equipment, $30,000 of inventory at cost and $220,000 cash, funded by the equity and debt shown above. The cash is a reserve at financing close, before any additional pre-opening expense. Legal work, training, lease deposits, advertising and carrying costs must be itemized before launch and either paid from this reserve or funded separately. They are not assumed to disappear. This teaching model starts with no accounts payable, receivables or customer deposits; real opening balances must be substituted when known.

## Illustrative revenue drivers

| Driver | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Primary annual units / equivalents** | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| **Net revenue per primary unit** | $360,000 | $450,000 | $520,000 |
| **Primary revenue** | $360,000 | $450,000 | $520,000 |
| **Secondary / add-on revenue** | $180,000 | $250,000 | $320,000 |
| **Total revenue** | $540,000 | $700,000 | $840,000 |

Illustrative operating assumptions; primary units are defined in section 3

Section 3 defines the primary unit and explains any blended project, channel or contract equivalent. A blended unit simplifies teaching; the supporting monthly workbook must split services, products and prices whenever their margins differ. Secondary revenue has its own demand and delivery requirements. It is not an automatic percentage earned by every primary customer. Refunds, credits, discounts and uncollectible balances need an explicit policy before these assumed net receipts become a usable forecast. Increasing volume also requires enough people, equipment, space and time to deliver the work.

## Illustrative three-year pro-forma income statement

| Line | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Primary revenue** | $360,000 | $450,000 | $520,000 |

| Line | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Secondary / add-on revenue** | $180,000 | $250,000 | $320,000 |
| **Total revenue** | $540,000 | $700,000 | $840,000 |
| **Direct supplies, merchandise and channel costs** | $225,000 | $295,000 | $358,000 |
| **Gross contribution before employee payroll** | $315,000 | $405,000 | $482,000 |
| **Employee payroll, owner work and employer costs** | $190,000 | $230,000 | $270,000 |
| **Rent and occupancy** | $60,000 | $63,000 | $66,000 |
| **Other operating overhead** | $70,000 | $82,000 | $94,000 |
| **EBITDA** | ($5,000) | $30,000 | $52,000 |
| **Depreciation** | $55,000 | $55,000 | $55,000 |
| **Interest** | $24,000 | $21,600 | $19,200 |
| **Profit / (loss) before tax** | ($84,000) | ($46,600) | ($22,200) |
| **Hypothetical tax provision** | $0 | $0 | $0 |
| **Net income / (loss)** | ($84,000) | ($46,600) | ($22,200) |

Illustrative annual pro-forma income statement, CAD

Direct costs follow the industry assumptions in section 3. Employee payroll is presented separately from materials and purchased services. For the brokerage, agent splits are direct costs; for the contractor, purchased trade work is direct cost. Other overhead is an illustrative envelope covering insurance, administration, marketing, professional advice, software, maintenance and industry-specific operating support. It must be replaced by itemized quotes and contracts, with care to avoid charging the same expense twice. The working owner receives compensation within payroll; the model does not assume unpaid owner labour makes the business sustainable.

Borrowing interest is assumed at six per cent of each year’s opening debt balance, purely as a simplified annual calculation. This is not a current lender quotation. Principal repayments are separate cash outflows and do not reduce accounting profit. Depreciation is an illustrative accounting charge on the asset pool; it is not a Canadian tax allowance schedule. A hypothetical fifteen per cent provision is applied to positive modeled taxable income after earlier modeled losses. That percentage and loss treatment are teaching conventions, not a statutory tax rate, tax opinion or assurance that losses can be used in this way.

## Illustrative working capital and cash flow

Year-end ordinary receivables are assumed at 5 per cent of annual revenue and supplier payables at 4 per cent of annual direct cost. Opening inventory is $30,000; the year-end inventory assumption is unchanged in Year 1, then

fifteen per cent and thirty per cent above that opening amount in Years 2 and 3. Those are stock-planning assumptions, not regulatory ratios. Construction receivables combine an illustrative ten per cent holdback component with five per cent ordinary timing balances; actual earned holdbacks and release dates must be scheduled job by job. Other businesses do not inherit construction holdbacks. The event venue alone includes customer deposits at an illustrative eight per cent of annual earned revenue, held as a separate liability for future events. That balance is not additional earned sales.

The working-capital movement below is the cash effect of changes in receivables, inventory, supplier payables and applicable customer deposits. A positive figure releases or supplies cash; a negative figure uses cash. Taxes and interest are assumed paid in the period included in net income. No dividends, asset-sale proceeds, new debt draws or grant receipts are assumed. Capital replacements begin in Year 2 at three per cent of original installed asset cost. A real replacement schedule should follow actual equipment condition and supplier advice, not a uniform percentage.

| Line | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Opening cash** | $220,000 | $133,000 | $75,200 |
| **Net income / (loss)** | ($84,000) | ($46,600) | ($22,200) |
| **Add back depreciation** | $55,000 | $55,000 | $55,000 |
| **Working-capital cash movement** | ($18,000) | ($9,700) | ($8,980) |
| **Operating cash flow** | ($47,000) | ($1,300) | $23,820 |
| **Capital replacements paid** | $0 | $16,500 | $16,500 |
| **Loan principal paid** | $40,000 | $40,000 | $40,000 |
| **Closing operating cash** | $133,000 | $75,200 | $42,520 |

Illustrative annual cash flow, CAD; capital and principal rows are outflows

## Illustrative year-end balance sheets

| Line | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cash** | $133,000 | $75,200 | $42,520 |
| **Accounts receivable / relevant holdbacks** | $27,000 | $35,000 | $42,000 |
| **Inventory at cost** | $30,000 | $34,500 | $39,000 |
| **Fit-out and equipment, net** | $495,000 | $456,500 | $418,000 |

| Line | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Total assets** | $685,000 | $601,200 | $541,520 |
| **Supplier payables** | $9,000 | $11,800 | $14,320 |
| **Customer deposits for future service** | $0 | $0 | $0 |
| **Loan outstanding, total** | $360,000 | $320,000 | $280,000 |
| **Owner share capital** | $400,000 | $400,000 | $400,000 |
| **Cumulative retained earnings / (deficit)** | ($84,000) | ($130,600) | ($152,800) |
| **Total liabilities and equity** | $685,000 | $601,200 | $541,520 |

Illustrative pro-forma balance sheets, CAD

The loan line combines its current and longer-term portions solely to keep this teaching balance sheet compact; a lender submission should classify them using actual repayment dates. Retained earnings equal cumulative modeled net income with no dividends. Net fixed assets equal installed cost plus replacements less cumulative depreciation. Cash links directly to the cash-flow statement. Brokerage client trust balances are excluded from both operating assets and liabilities here; actual trust books and required reporting remain separate. These simplifications must be disclosed rather than mistaken for a complete set of professional financial statements.

## Illustrative break-even and combined downside

Using the Year 2 channel mix, gross contribution before employee payroll is $405,000 divided by $700,000, or 57.9 per cent. Fixed operating expenses are $375,000. Dividing those expenses by the contribution fraction gives an illustrative EBITDA break-even revenue of about $648,148 annually. Adding the assumed Year 2 interest and principal produces a simplified cash debt-service threshold of about $754,617, before replacement capital, tax and working-capital changes. This is not a promise that the business can reach either level. Payroll and other costs may step up before the necessary volume is delivered.

An illustrative ten per cent reduction in Year 2 receipts at the same channel mix reduces contribution by approximately $40,500 if direct costs vary as assumed. A simultaneous ten per cent payroll overrun adds $23,000 of cost. Combined, these stresses reduce the modeled Year 2 EBITDA of $30,000 by $63,500 before any remedial action. Management must also test an opening delay and slower collections month by month. A positive year-end cash number cannot prove that payroll can be paid during the lowest-cash week. If the revised reserve is inadequate, the founder must obtain more committed equity, reduce a genuinely avoidable cost or redesign the launch before proceeding.

# 9. Sample funding request

The fictional request is $400,000 borrowing alongside $400,000 owner equity. Management will provide a dated sources-and-uses schedule, evidence of equity, equipment and fit-out quotations, premises terms, relevant authorization milestones and a monthly repayment model. The six per cent interest convention in section 8 is an assumption, not an offer; amortization, fees, security, guarantees, covenants and availability must follow actual written lender terms.

The Canada Small Business Financing Program hub can help organize financing research. This sample does not assert program eligibility, a loan entitlement or that every proposed use belongs in one financing category. Management will check current program rules and lender requirements before assigning costs to a particular route. A lender's decision depends on the actual borrower, evidence, security and repayment assessment; a business plan cannot guarantee approval.

Release of funds should follow a practical readiness checklist. Do not pay for equipment that cannot be installed at the selected site, or exhaust the reserve before required authorization is resolved. If a lender offers less than the request, management must revise the sources and uses and test the smaller launch before accepting the facility. Our business plan writing services can help connect the verified evidence and financial schedules into a consistent submission.

## 10. Sample appendix and official-source register

The appendix should make the plan reviewable without forcing a lender or partner to guess where an input came from. Include ownership and signing records, founder and key-manager experience, a premises due-diligence file, itemized supplier quotes, insurance terms, applicable registration or licensing evidence, staffing schedules and the monthly financial workbook. Keep personal or commercially sensitive material in an appropriately restricted supporting file rather than publishing it as sample content.

For every material assumption, record its definition, source, date, owner and next review trigger. A quotation supports cost; an interview supports a limited demand observation; a regulator's page supports the stated rule. None substitutes for the others. When an assumption changes, update the operating narrative, financial statements and funding request together. The PDF below reproduces this sample, while your actual application requires your own evidence and current official confirmation.

- Ontario — O. Reg. 746/21, Licensing — supports the regulatory discussion in section 5; checked October 26, 2026.
- Canada Revenue Agency — ED200-1, Licensing requirements for manufacturers of beer — supports the regulatory discussion in section 5; checked October 26, 2026.

**Details deliberately omitted or left qualitative:** Excise duty rates, small-brewer thresholds, provincial beer-tax rates, mandatory production volumes and obsolete by-the-glass licence descriptions are omitted.

Final adaptation checks: confirm the exact site and permitted use, cost the actual roster, obtain current supplier terms, reconcile all three statements and test the lowest monthly cash point. Resolve any condition that prevents lawful opening before taking unconditional commitments. The purpose of this ten-section example is to show how the evidence connects, not to certify that a fictional operation is ready to open.

## Frequently asked questions

## What does this brewery business plan sample include?

It includes a fictional Canadian company, ten plan sections, a defined operating model, three-year illustrative income statements, cash flow and balance sheets, a conditional funding request and an official-source register. Replace the sample company, location, costs and demand assumptions with your own evidence before using it for a real decision.

## How much funding does this fictional brewery need?

The selected illustration uses $800,000 of total opening capitalization, including $400,000 equity and $400,000 requested borrowing. This is a teaching scenario, not a typical industry startup cost. Actual premises, equipment,

stock, payroll and pre-opening delays determine the real requirement.

## How do taproom sales, wholesale and excise licensing differ?

Taproom and wholesale receipts use different assumed cost ratios and collection patterns. Provincial manufacturer licensing and sales permissions must be reviewed separately from CRA beer-excise licensing. The forecast includes a provisional commercial compliance-cost envelope rather than a quoted excise rate. Production, tank time, packaging, losses and seasonal demand must reconcile before either channel forecast is usable.

## Are the three-year financials a forecast or profit promise?

No. Every commercial input and financial statement is illustrative. The income, cash-flow and balance-sheet schedules show how assumptions connect, including losses, debt service and working capital. Actual results depend on demand, delivery costs, timing and many other factors; neither revenue nor profit nor financing approval is assured.

## Can I download and adapt this brewery business plan example?

Yes. The linked PDF reproduces the full sample, and the online sections provide an adaptation structure. Use the sample hub to compare models and the generator to organize a first draft. Before submission, replace fictional material, obtain current quotations and official confirmations, and review the reconciled monthly model with qualified advisers.




### Written by Atul Jagga, CPA Ontario

Founder of The Biz Plans, Toronto. MBA Finance & Strategy (UBC); 20+ years in corporate finance and consulting involving RBC, BMO, and CIBC. Since 2016, Atul has written bank-financing and investor business plans for Canadian startups and small businesses. About Atul · Professional plan writing services


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